Phishing Email Investigation Report (Crypto Scam)

1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes a phishing email impersonating CoinDesk and promoting fake Ripple (XRP) rewards. The attacker used legitimate email infrastructure (Mailgun) to bypass authentication checks and deliver malicious links.

2. Email Overview

Sender: coindesk@mg.areafellowship.com

Subject: More benefits from Ripple with the Allocation Program

Attack Type: Crypto Phishing Scam

3. Header Analysis

SPF: PASS

DKIM: PASS

DMARC: BESTGUESSPASS

SCL: 9 (High Spam Score)

Conclusion: Even though authentication passed, high spam confidence and domain mismatch indicate phishing.

4. IP Analysis

IP Address: 198.61.254.55

ISP: Mailgun Technologies Inc (Rackspace Hosting)

Country: United States

The IP belongs to a legitimate email service provider but has prior abuse reports, indicating possible misuse for phishing campaigns.

5. Domain Analysis

Domain: areafellowship.com

Registrar: GoDaddy

Created: 2019

The domain is unrelated to CoinDesk, confirming domain mismatch and impersonation attempt.

6. URL Analysis

Suspicious Domain: mail123-ripple.net

The email contains redirect links leading to a suspicious domain, likely used for phishing or data harvesting.

7. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IP: 198.61.254.55

Domain: mg.areafellowship.com

Domain: mail123-ripple.net

8. Conclusion

This email is confirmed as a phishing attack using brand impersonation and malicious links. Despite passing authentication checks, multiple indicators such as domain mismatch, suspicious URLs, and high spam score confirm malicious intent.